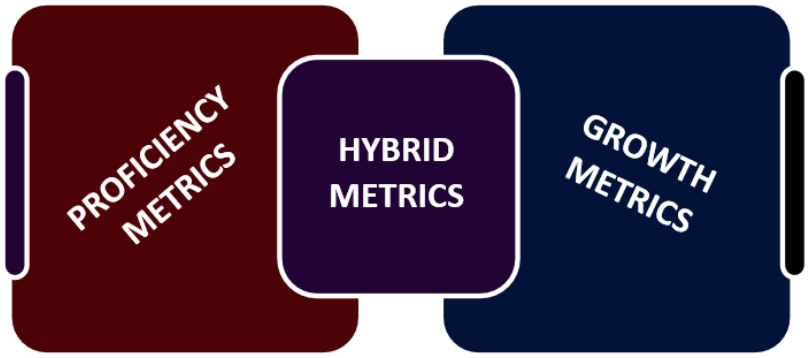
Section 1: Introduction

EvalzNow is the first evaluation tool that can calculate proficiency metrics, growth metrics, and hybrid metrics for users at any level – candidate, unit, or institution. (See the Figure below)



Proficiency in learning, which passes the accountability to the student/worker, is a metric that is used to determine if a candidate can meet or can exceed a predefined benchmark or a baseline threshold. This determination is normally based on the candidate's ability to demonstrate mastery of core concepts at a fixed point in time. (Static Metric)

Growth in learning, which passes the accountability to the instructor/manager, refers to the differential changes in skills from one performance point to another performance point. These differential changes, which can be correlated with normative measures at a candidate level, a unit level, or an institutional level, indicate the direction of candidate progress. (Dynamic Metric)

The determination of proficiency metrics, hybrid metrics, and growth metrics is based on a series of complex calculations that reveal how the receptive variables and the productive variables are interacting when learning skills are put to the test. Under ideal circumstances, the interactions between receptive variables and productive variables should be balanced. To channel this balance, the instructor/manager must have the ability to identify student/employee weaknesses and to correct these weaknesses using sound teaching techniques. The identification of weaknesses and the mitigation of weaknesses should always be stored in a Needs Assessment file because this file serves as a record of the actions and the contributions of the instructor/manager and the student/employee during the learning process.

EvalzNow eases the Needs Assessment process by tracking open action items related to the following assessment types:

Company Objective Assessment: This assessment is conducted to determine if an employee can meet/maintain a specific company objective or a job-related skill (E.G. CPD, CMP, upskilling, reskilling, etc)

Confirmative Assessment: This assessment, which normally involves scaffolding, is conducted after the implementation of a new learning target to prove that students have internalized key concepts of a new learning target, to reinforce learning through repetition, or to reduce lesson plans from a classroom level to an individual level. This assessment is often seen as an extension of the Summative Assessment.

Deviation: This assessment is conducted when a candidate deviates from protocol, pre-defined standard, or work procedure after discovering, identifying, or isolating an issue in need of mitigation, resolution, or improvement. Depending on the risk level, the candidate might act autonomously or collaboratively.

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Diagnostic Assessment: This assessment is conducted prior to the implementation of a new learning target to determine a candidate's strengths, a candidate's weaknesses, and a candidate's initial knowledge of the new learning target.

Formative Assessment: This assessment is conducted during the implementation of a new learning target to identify gaps in learning, to provide instructor feedback on student learning, and to adjust lesson plans.

Gifted & Talented Assessment: This assessment is conducted to determine if a candidate is performing exceptionally beyond expectations, especially in logical reasoning, critical thinking, and problem-solving.

Human Capital Assessment: This assessment is conducted to determine if an employee is an asset to a company or if a unit (department, section, division, etc.) is an asset to a company.

IEP Objective Assessment: This assessment is conducted after the individualized educational plan has been approved by the instructor, administrators, and parents (sometimes custodians).

Innovative Assessment: This assessment enables the transfer of knowledge, skills, competencies, and dispositions in unexplored areas.

Investigative Assessment: This assessment refers to the information-gathering process, which includes interviews, logs, root-cause analysis, forensic evaluations, pictures, videos, and other evidentiary findings.

Ipsative Assessment: This assessment is conducted after the implementation of a new learning target to compare the performance of a student or the performance of a group of students with the previous performance results of a student or the previous performance results of a group of students. Such an assessment can be used for curriculum revamping, course optimization, and student learning style inclusion.

Key Performance Assessment: This assessment is conducted to determine if an employee, a unit, or a company can meet a metric, which has been deemed critical or necessary for business development, business sustainment, and company growth. These are direct tasks tied to the key performance indicators of a company.

Neuro-Linguistic Programming: This assessment is a psychological approach that utilizes strategies observed among successful individuals to achieve specific objectives. The approach includes behavior patterns, (non)verbal application, selective language, and adaptive changes in learning or in communication.

Norm-Referenced Assessment: This assessment is conducted after the implementation of a new learning target to compare a student's performance to the performance of an entire class or of an entire school for a given subject.

One-Time Assessment: This assessment is conducted to baseline the performance of students or employees against a set goal.

Original Assessment: This assessment initiates a new learning target regardless of whether a diagnostic assessment has been performed or not. All future assessment linkage is sourced from the Original Assessment in EvalzNow.

Risk Assessment: This assessment is geared toward identifying, analyzing, and resolving threats, risks, and/or processes manifesting in company work cycles, situations, and personnel shortcomings.

Routine Assessment: This assessment is conducted at regular intervals to determine if an employee meets the demands of the job function continuously. This includes continued professional development.

Tech Target Assessments: This assessment is conducted in accordance with design principles to determine if employees/teams are effectively developing a product given a framework of rules, roles, events, and artifacts. Examples include Agile, SCRUM, Spiral, V workflow, Waterfall, Incremental, RAD dev, RUP dev, domain-driven dev, test-driven dev, data security, and behavior-driven dev.

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SEND Objective Assessment: This assessment is conducted to determine if a candidate has a learning disability or an observed educational need that requires focalized support. The user is cautioned to use EvalzNow carefully when dealing with candidates whom suffer from diminished mental capacity or permanent brain damage because it impedes brain interaction.

SMART Goal Assessment: This assessment is conducted to determine if an employee can meet a metric, which has been deemed critical or necessary for the successful completion of a project or a program. The acronym means specific, measurable, achievable, relevant/realistic, and time-bound.

Special Assessment: This assessment is conducted to identify if a student is well beyond a given level (gifted and talented), if a student requires a learning specialist (learning deficient), or if a student requires additional testing to support a claim.

Summative Assessment: This assessment, which is normally cumulative, is conducted after the implementation of a new learning target to evaluate benchmark outcomes, to measure the effectiveness of the new learning target, to refine lesson plans, and to determine the long-term benefits of the new learning target on student learning.

The Needs Assessment Module of EvalzNow also allows the user to map benchmarks and performance points among related assessment chains to track candidate outcomes in education and industry.

Ideally, the user should always try to create forward linkages in the chain. This means that successive positive performance points and successive negative performance points should always be greater than the previous performance point number in the assessment chain. When done correctly, the user can determine the effectiveness of assessment choices, the environmental pressures (classroom or workforce), the applicable benchmarks, and the status of the workflow actions across critical reference dates. All connectivity among performance points can be tracked via the filter feature.

Since EvalzNow is an evidence-based system based on the completion of assigned tasks, EvalzNow automatically maps the record of assignments associated with a given performance point. This mapping, which is shown below, is compatible with holistic learning methods and systematic learning methods.

With EvalzNow being an evidence-based system at the candidate level, the unit level, and the institutional level, it can also be used in evaluating key performance indicators (KPI). KPIs, by definition, are quantifiable measures that demonstrate how effective a company is at achieving key business objectives. As long as the business objectives are either associated with human competency or delegated as hard tasks/assignments across a given evaluation period, a key performance assessment falls within the scope of the human capital assessment. The table below illustrates some examples of when an item is within the scope or outside of the scope for both, education and industry.

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KPI	Description	EvalzNow Perspective	Scope
Student evaluations of the quality of the courses	Average overall rating of final-year students for the quality of learning experience in the program on a five-point scale in an annual survey	These types of evaluations are not evidence-based against teaching criteria, and an instructor does not report to a student.	Outside
Completion rates	The proportion of undergraduate students whom completed the program in the minimum time in each cohort	Each unit and each candidate are tracked across an unlimited period. The college can combine the socioeconomic cohorts with min. Time requirements to determine KPI pass/fail criteria	Within
Student performance in Professional and/or national examinations	Percentage of students or graduates whom were successful in the professional and/or national examinations, or their score average and median (if any)	The attained scores must be incorporated as an Assessment Block. The content of the examinations must apply to an existing Unit and the Unit Type.	Within
Employer evaluation of the program graduate's proficiency	Average overall rating of employers for the proficiency of the program graduates on a five-point scale in an annual survey.	The employer must provide a full list of tasks/assignments, as well as the assessment markings and attained scores. The survey can be incorporated on the qualitative side after the quantitative results are generated.	Within
The proportion of teaching staff leaving the program	The proportion of teaching staff leaving the program annually for reasons other than age retirement to the total number of teaching staff	The assessment profiles can be maintained, and reasons for employee vacancy can be recorded; however, the proportion is not captured.	Outside
Student Needs Requirement	Decrease at-risk student rates to 10% or less per unit based on proficiency	This KPI requires an instructor or a trainer to develop lesson plans to raise the competency levels of at-risk students. An assessment cannot take place until another performance point is generated from the lesson plan.	Outside
Student Needs Requirement	Identify at-risk student rates at 10% or less per unit based on growth	All quantifiable data associated with student competency can be tracked for proficiency and growth, so student status (failing, at-risk, exceptional, etc.) will always be known.	Within
Percentage of publications of faculty members	Percentage of full-time faculty members whom published at least one (1) research paper during the year to total faculty members in the program	The assessment of the published work is more important than the percentage of faculty submitting work.	Outside
Annual faculty publication requirement	Faculty Members are to submit at least one (1) publication per year	Unlike the case above, the hard requirement forces a mandatory task/assignment to be assessed for publication per year.	Within
Customer retention	A general goal to hold retention at or above 35%	The KPI does not contain a specific task and/or assignment to achieve the goal.	Outside
Customer retention	Maintain CRM response time ≤ 48 hours.	The CRM response time must be converted to a 3-point or a 5-point assessment scale to become a task entry for the assignee.	Within
Customer penetration	Evaluate e-mail correspondence	The evaluation of the e-mail and the response to the e-mail must be converted to a 3-point or a 5-point assessment scale to become a task entry for the assignee.	Within
Capital expenditure	Drop the CapExp limit to $1 million.	The KPI does not contain a specific task and/or assignment to achieve the goal.	Outside
Refinery capacity	Procure pipeline networks	The assessment can be performed at this level, but the procurement should be broken down further into sub-tasks (feasibility studies, RFQ, RFP, budget draft, etc.)	Within
Store portfolio changes	Create a new product line.	The assessment can be performed at this level, but the creation should be broken down into sub-tasks (brainstorming, pitching, modification, pricing, sourcing, etc.)	Within
Sales per Year	Generate 2500 sales per year	The assessment can be performed, but the user should consider sales per month to increase the fidelity of the results.	Within
Orders per Month	Deliver 10 orders per day	The assessment can be performed after the user creates a 3-point or 5-point assessment scale for ranges below the order-per-day limit.	Within
Grow Staff by 50%	10-year progressive goal	The assessment can only be performed if the task/assignment has been delegated to an employee and there are onboarding targets set within the 10-year period.	Within

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All users are encouraged to use EvalzNow as a tool for:

- Collaborating with professional colleagues to support student learning objectives (SLO)
- Setting complex pass/fail thresholds that incorporate both, proficiency and growth
- Evaluating how demographics or socioeconomic factors can play a secondary role in learning
- Determining how instructors can design lessons to teach a larger range of students
- Responding to learning difficulties in a timely, yet objective, way
- Holding students/employees and instructors/managers accountable in the learning/L&D process
- Conducting comparative analyses at the candidate level, the unit level, and the institutional level
- Determining how students/employees can be reasonably challenged at any level
- Determining if students/employees are engaged in the classroom/workplace
- Maintaining a complete record of student achievement and individualized educational plans (IEP)
- Reporting candidate achievement to the administration for feedback
- Integrating curriculum expectations into current teaching practice
- Reflecting on current practice to determine if the needs of students are being met
- Modifying and refining teaching approaches alongside quantitative observations
- Making growth projections using practical interpolation/extrapolation schemes
- Monitoring candidate progress and candidate growth rates
- Investing in corporate training
- Overseeing and auditing different management groups
- Juxtaposing data analytics (quantitative assessments) with unit observations (qualitative assessments)
- Ranking entities based on objective, academic, and quantitative data analytics

EvalzNow calculates an index based on the weighted average of objective metrics associated with the learning process. The intent of the metrics is to determine whether educational institutions, corporate sub-units, or training programs are meeting the needs of students/companies over a given period. Since the index is derived from quantitative factors, it does not include socioeconomic factors and qualitative assessments; therefore, users should juxtapose the index with qualitative assessments and socioeconomic factors within the software to make critical decisions.

The index ratings, subject to the calculated index value from highest to lowest, are provided below:

- Overperforming
- Above Average
- Average – Upper End
- Average – Mid
- Average – Lower End
- Below Average
- Underperforming
- Negligent

The EvalzNow Team, as well as Ricky D. Butler for the same matter, will not be held liable for the decisions of the End User and the actions of the End User based on the subjective interpretations of data outputs contained within EvalzNow. EvalzNow is a tool, and we caution educators, companies, and administrators to exercise sound judgment based on experience and first-hand accounts when utilizing input/output data.

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